

NDMA Earthquake Response Protocol 2020

EARTHQUAKE RESPONSE PROTOCOL 2020

1.1 Before Earthquake

- Secure heavy furniture and appliances to walls
- Identify safe spots in each room: under sturdy tables, against interior walls
- Keep emergency kit accessible with water, food, first aid
- Know how to shut off gas, water, and electricity
- Practice earthquake drills with family

1.2 During Earthquake - Drop, Cover, Hold On

- DROP to hands and knees to prevent being knocked down
- COVER head and neck under a sturdy table or desk
- HOLD ON to shelter until shaking stops
- If outdoors, move to open area away from buildings
- If driving, pull over, stop, and stay inside vehicle

1.3 After Earthquake

- Check for injuries and provide first aid
- Inspect building for damage before re-entering
- Expect aftershocks - be prepared to take cover
- Do not use damaged elevators
- Report damaged infrastructure to authorities

2.1 Building Safety Assessment

- Check for structural damage: cracks, tilted walls, shifted foundation
- Do not enter severely damaged buildings
- Mark unsafe buildings for demolition
- Use professional assessors for evaluation

2.2 Utilities Safety

- Check for gas leaks - smell or hissing sounds
- If gas leak suspected, open windows, do not use electrical switches
- Report utility damage to authorities
- Do not use water until supply is confirmed safe

3.1 Seismic Zone V

- Uttarakhand falls in highest seismic zone (Zone V)
- Chamoli district experienced 6.8 magnitude earthquake in 1999
- Regular tremors are common - stay prepared
- Traditional stone houses are vulnerable to shaking

3.2 Emergency Shelters

- Designated earthquake shelters at community centers
- Open ground assembly points in each district
- Medical teams stationed at district hospitals
- SDRF teams on standby during monsoon season